



Help Intel develop its future GPUs

"The Odyssey", a community program by Intel will allow users to share ideas on how company should develop future GPUs. <http://bit.ly/mar19-79>



Foldable Laptop from Microsoft

A recent Microsoft patent suggests that the company might be planning a laptop with foldable screen. <https://dgit.in/mar19-80>

Thermaltake X1 RGB

The best mechanical keyboard you can buy

Thermaltake had unveiled the X1 RGB mechanical keyboard at Computex 2018. Although the design wasn't revolutionary, what they implemented with software was new in the keyboard industry. The keyboard can connect to your smartphone through an app (present on both Android and iOS) and several functions can be controlled conveniently. However, is this innovation really required and does it actually work?

Features and accessories

For the USB passthrough, you'll find a USB 2.0 standard, so don't expect high data transfer speeds. Whereas, the audio

passthrough is an audio and mic combo port, so if your headphone has individual connectors for audio out and mic in, only one can be used.

It has support for full N-key rollover, so all the keystrokes will be registered by the keyboard. There's an endless number of lighting effects added to the keyboard. If that doesn't satisfy you enough, then you can further customise the backlighting from the X1 RGB Gaming Keyboard software utility.

Build quality and design

As a premium mechanical keyboard, the Thermaltake X1 RGB packs a sturdy body. It follows the floating key design. There's a plastic layer on top and underneath that, an aluminium frame is installed.

ABS keycaps are used on the X1 RGB and all the legends are laser-etched onto them. It incorporates a neutral font without the gamer-ish quirks. Although other knock-offs or MX-compatible switches aren't that bad, Cherry's durability has stood the test of time for decades. On paper, they



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offer a 50-million keystroke lifecycle that should last you way past the rest of your components. The keyboard offers MX Blue and MX Speed switch variants.

You get a braided cable that bundles three individual cables including the keyboard data, USB passthrough and audio passthrough connector. Both the USB connectors are gold-plated while the 3.5mm audio jack isn't. You get enough rubber padding below the keyboard to prevent any kind of slipping. The two rubber feet towards the top are extendable and both of them have a rubber layer.

Gaming and typing performance

We played a bunch of games using the Thermaltake X1 RGB including FPS, RTS and MOBA games. There weren't any input lag errors nor any kind of anomalies observed while gaming. Our review unit had Blue switches that are catered more towards typing. Using the software utility, we recorded macros and found no problems with them. The feature of multiple profiles made it easier to assign different profiles to different games and switch between them right from the keyboard whenever needed.

After rigorously typing on the X1 RGB, we didn't find any problems, including any signs of chatter.

Verdict

The Thermaltake X1 RGB manages to cover all the aspects that we expect to see in mechanical keyboards at this price range. Its build quality will ensure that the keyboard lasts you for more than a decade, considering the Cherry MX switches packed inside. The rest of the components also don't compromise in build quality. RGB lighting, more customisable with the software, can also be controlled without. Something that makes the Thermaltake X1 RGB more interesting is the capability of controlling the lighting effects using a smartphone app. Although certain functions are still buggy including virtual keyboard and voice support, lighting control works without any problems. The keyboard also went on to win Digit's Zerol Award in the mechanical keyboard category last year. Whatever premium feature you could ask for in a gaming and mechanical keyboard, the X1 RGB has it all. However, in order to acquire the entire package, you will have to shell out a premium price as well.

—Abhijit Dey

SPECIFICATIONS

KEYBOARD SIZE: Standard, Numpad included (104-keys) | KEYBOARD BACKLIGHTING: RGB | SWITCH TYPE: Mechanical (Cherry Blue 50-million lifecycle) | POLLING RATE: 1000Hz (1 ms) | KEY-ROLLOVER: Full-key rollover | INTERFACE: USB 2.0 | DIMENSIONS: Wide - 46.4 cm, Length - 17 cm, Height - 4.03 cm | CABLE LENGTH: 1.8m | WARRANTY: 2 years

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Price
₹16,999